Epic Breakdown Canvas

Turn a big idea into an MVP, a handful of valuable features, and the first stories a team can start.

Break Down Work · Epic Hypothesis · Minimum Viable Product · Feature Slicing

EPIC _____

OWNER _____

1 Epic Hypothesis

WHY ARE WE DOING THIS?

For... _____ (the customers or users)

who... _____ (have this need or problem)

the... _____ (epic name)

is a... _____ (what it is: product, service, capability)

that... _____ (provides this value)

unlike... _____ (the current solution or competitor)

our solution... _____ (does this better)

2 Outcomes & Measures

Business outcomes: how we'll know it worked

Leading indicators: early signals

3 Minimum Viable Product

TEST IT SMALL

Smallest thing that tests the hypothesis:

Persevere if... _____

Pivot or stop if... _____

4 Features

SPLIT THE EPIC INTO 3-8 FEATURES THAT EACH DELIVER VALUE

FEATURE 1

Name:

Benefit:

Size: ☐ S ☐ M ☐ L ☐ XL

☐ Part of the MVP

FEATURE 2

Name:

Benefit:

Size: ☐ S ☐ M ☐ L ☐ XL

☐ Part of the MVP

FEATURE 3

Name:

Benefit:

Size: ☐ S ☐ M ☐ L ☐ XL

☐ Part of the MVP

FEATURE 4

Name:

Benefit:

Size: ☐ S ☐ M ☐ L ☐ XL

☐ Part of the MVP

FEATURE 5

Name:

Benefit:

Size: ☐ S ☐ M ☐ L ☐ XL

☐ Part of the MVP

5 First Stories

FROM THE MVP FEATURES

- Slice vertically: each story is usable end-to-end
- Too big for an iteration? Use the Story Splitting poster

Add your sticky notes here

6 Out of Scope & NFRs

We are explicitly not doing:

Non-functional needs (security, scale...):

7 Dependencies & Risks

- Other teams, systems or suppliers we need
- What could stop or delay this?

Add your sticky notes here

"What's the smallest thing we could build to learn whether this epic is worth it?"

"Which feature, if it were the only one, would still deliver value?"

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